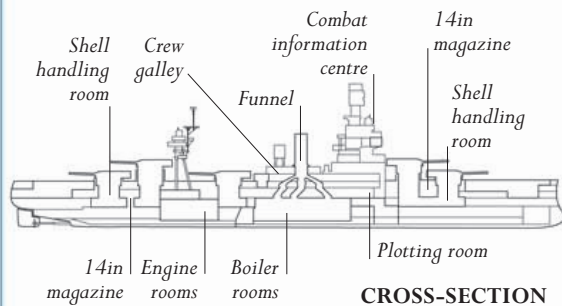


BELOW DECKS

Home to a complement of about 1,800 men and officers by 1945, the *Texas* was like a small town, with a post office, dentist, and barber's shops – but no liquor store, as alcohol consumption was banned on all US Navy ships. There were few frills on board: most men ate where they slept, and toilet and bathing facilities were quite primitive. It was, however, a well-organized world in which each man knew his place, and in which basic needs of health and nutrition were properly addressed.



COMMAND AND CONTROL



▲ COMBAT ROOM

Staff in the Combat Information Centre assessed data from the radar (a World War II addition) and other sources. They also coordinated the weapons systems.



▲ PILOT HOUSE

The pilot house, located on the bridge, contained the main steering position. It was equipped with wheel, compass, rudder-angle indicator, and engine room telegraph.

◀ CHART ROOM

Adjacent to the pilot house, the chart room was where the navigating officer worked. The devices on the wall above the chart table are depth and speed indicators.

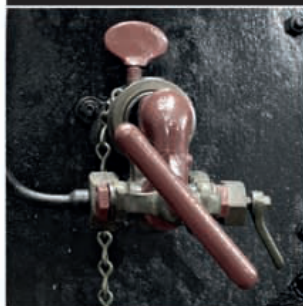
SHELLS AND POWDER



▲ 14IN SHELL HOIST

Shells and charges stored in magazines well below the water line were brought up to the handling rooms and readied for use.

BOILERS AND RUDDER



◀ BURNER NOZZLE DETAIL

The burners forced fuel oil through atomizers, creating a spray of mist that was burned to heat the water. The red bar was used to adjust the volume and fineness of the spray.

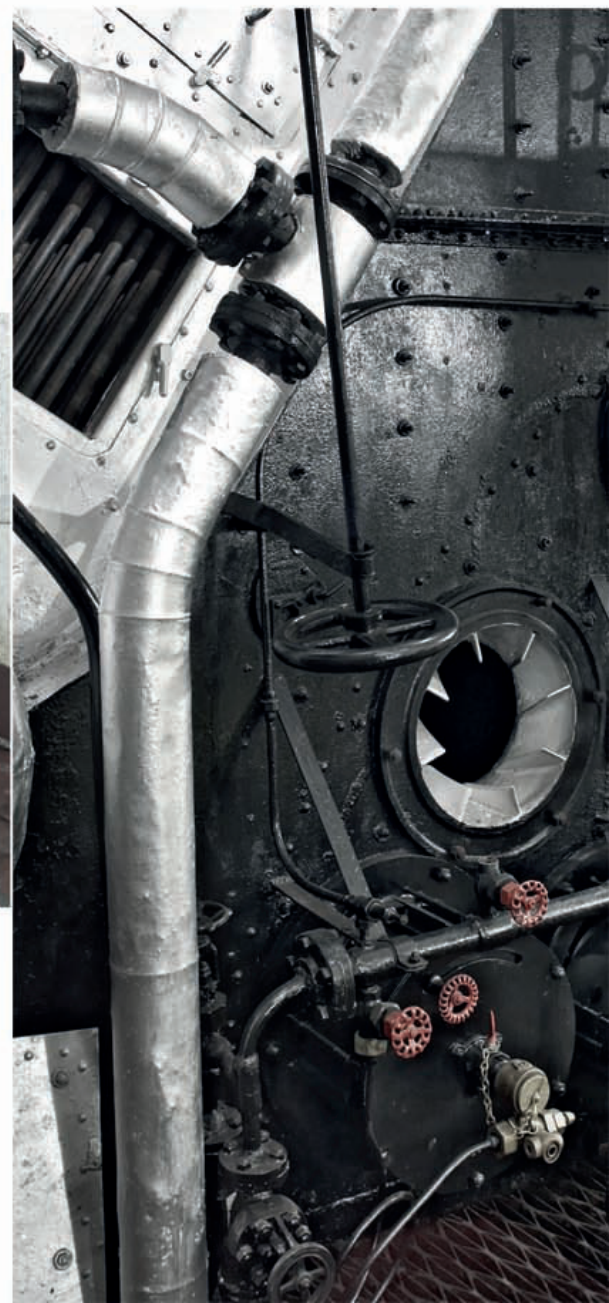


▲ EMERGENCY STEERING POSITION

Normally the twin rudders were turned by electric motors, but if the power failed, the ship could be steered manually by teams of 16 men, using four large wheels.

► OIL-FIRED BOILER

After the *Texas*'s refit in 1927, steam to drive the two vertical, triple-expanding engines was produced by six oil-fired boilers. Each boiler had eight burners; three have been removed here to reveal the interior.



▲ POWDER SCUTTLES

Propellant powder, stored far from the shells, was sent to the handling rooms via flash-proof scuttles to prevent accidental ignition.